

Chapter 67-6

//

The rain never stopped. Perhaps because she had thought too much about matters related to Qi Jiao during the day.

In her dream, she returned once again to her childhood.

In that dim little room, Qi Jiao, wearing a princess dress, sat side by side with her on the floor. There were scabbed-over red marks on her wrist, and then she turned over the back of her hand and opened her palm, revealing a round cookie.

She sniffled, "I'm sorry, I could only get this much. Eat it quickly."

Liang Shi looked at that cookie, reached out to take it, and asked Qi Jiao in a low voice: "Sister, why is your mother like this?"

Qi Jiao buried her head in her knees. She said: "Mom is also very pitiful."

"I saw Dad when he was drunk....." Halfway through Qi Jiao's words, she heard the sound of the door moving. She immediately snatched the cookie from Liang Shi's hand, then threw it on the ground, and the two of them huddled together.

Yang Jiani was still wearing a qipao¹, gracefully swaying, but the hem of her qipao had been torn off a section, her hair was disheveled, and there were bloodstains at the corner of her mouth.

Her gaze toward the two children was very cold. Suddenly she smiled, "Why were you born?"

She asked very seriously, then crouched down, "Being born is suffering. Why be born?"

Qi Jiao's body trembled, but she still raised her small hand, tremblingly touching Yang Jiani's injured face, asking with a crying voice: "Mom, does it hurt?"

"Hurt?" Yang Jiani sneered coldly: "You won't hurt if you're dead."

She licked the bloodstain on her lip, "So..... my precious Jiaojiao, do you want to die with me? I'll take you with me."

"Oh right, and you too." Yang Jiani looked at Liang Shi: "You're not likeable when you're alive anyway. Might as well come along with us."

"Mom." Qi Jiao leaned forward and hugged Yang Jiani, burying her head in her neck, crying as she said: "I don't want to die."

"But what can you do by living?" Yang Jiani scoffed, "Living is painful."

"Don't take little sister to die either." Qi Jiao said: "Jiaojiao will be very obedient, will listen. Little sister is also very obedient."

.....

In the dream, she kept falling, everything before her eyes was emptiness and darkness.

Then the scene changed. In a field covered with green grass, the moon hung high in the sky. It should have been a dreamy scene, but she, dressed in tattered clothes, was running wildly through the field with a little girl with disheveled hair.

As if they would never get tired.

And as if voices were coming from all directions, people constantly shouting: "Stop!"

The little girl following behind her fell to the ground, her knee scraped raw. She crouched down and said firmly: "Get on!"

They just kept running like that, running across the empty field, hiding beneath the field ridge.

Ice and snow melted, grass sprouted, and there was the sound of a stream flowing.

Liang Shi first covered the little girl's mouth, and only released her hand after the footsteps of those searching disappeared.

After a long while, the little girl asked: "Sister, can we escape?"

"Yes, we can." Liang Shi said.

"You should run by yourself." The little girl said in a low crying voice: "My leg is injured. I'll drag you down."

"No." Liang Shi said: "I must take you with me."

"Why?" The little girl asked: "I'm a burden now."

"Because a sister once told me that sisters are supposed to protect their little sisters." Liang Shi touched the little girl's head, "I'm the older sister."

"Do you have a sister?" the little girl asked.

Liang Shi said: "Not a real sister, but she was very good to me."

The little girl said: "I don't have any sisters."

"Silly." Liang Shi smiled, holding the thin-framed girl: "From now on I'm your sister. Don't be afraid, sister will always protect you."

After a while, the little girl suddenly said: "Look! Fireflies!"

Liang Shi immediately closed her eyes: "Quick, make a wish."

.....

Her body seemed to be suspended and drowning in the deep sea, with people constantly pulling her down.

Then she suddenly opened her eyes.

What she saw was a pure white ceiling, and overcast skies.

The rain had stopped, but it was still cloudy.

Liang Shi lay in bed gasping for breath, trying to calm the emotions the nightmare had brought her.

After the luck value reached 80, Liang Shi had obtained some memories from the system, or rather, from the original host.

But they were all fragmentary, without any important information.

And this was another time she had dreamed of things related to her childhood.

There were different scenes in the dream.

She and a little girl were fleeing for their lives across an empty field. They made wishes to fireflies. They were caught by a group of people.

Then the dream came to an abrupt end.

She didn't even know what it was about.

This was the first time memories related to this little girl had appeared in Liang Shi's mind.

It still felt like something she had personally experienced.

After going through those previous dream sequences, she could now basically determine which memories belonged to the original host and which belonged to her.

Very clearly, both of these segments belonged to her.

But she didn't know under what circumstances the second segment had occurred, nor did she know who the little girl was.

However, Liang Shi didn't dwell on it too much. She was more concerned about Qi Jiao.

The older sister who had protected her when she was little.

Thinking about it still made her feel sad.

Because they were returning to the Xu family today, Liang Shi adjusted her emotions in her room before going out.

But Xu Qingzhu still saw at a glance that she wasn't in good condition and asked if she had a nightmare.

Liang Shi nodded, "I dreamed of Qi Jiao."

Xu Qingzhu served her a bowl of congee². Liang Shi nodded and said thank you.

Xu Qingzhu smiled, "Then let's find the truth as soon as possible and clear her name."

After finishing the meal, those unpleasant emotions in Liang Shi's heart finally subsided somewhat.

Xu Qingzhu was preparing things for the memorial service. Liang Shi watched as she put those items into a backpack, and suddenly asked: "Xu Qingzhu, if one day you discovered that your parents weren't your biological parents, what would you do? Would you look for your biological parents?"

Xu Qingzhu froze.

She was so clever. A moment later, she suddenly asked back with a smile: "Are you talking about me or are you talking about yourself?"

Footnotes:

¹ Qipao: Also known as cheongsam, a traditional form-fitting Chinese dress for women with a high collar and side slits. It originated in the 1920s-1930s in Shanghai and became iconic Chinese formal wear. The qipao is often associated with elegance and sophistication.

² Congee: Known as "粥" (zhōu) in Chinese, this is a rice porridge that's a staple breakfast food in Chinese cuisine. It's made by boiling rice in a large amount of water until it breaks down into a thick, creamy consistency. It's considered easy to digest and comforting, often served when someone is sick or as a light meal.